Local Music Organizer

User Guide - Early Access macOS Utility for Local Music.app Libraries
Version target: 0.4 Early Access
macOS 14 Sonoma or later
Apple Silicon recommended - Intel supported in Universal builds

> Read this first: Local Music Organizer is designed for careful users with large local Music.app libraries. Keep backups before cleanup, tag editing, Repair / Convert, File Maintenance, playlist removal, or any operation that changes Music.app records or local files.

1. What the app is for

- Inspect Music.app library quality: missing files, missing artwork, bitrate, codec, sample rate, duration, short tracks, storage, and outlier records.
- Compare playlists, find repeated entries, and understand where a track is used before editing, removing, repairing, or moving files.
- Run Health Check on the full Music.app library, selected playlists, or a physical folder.
- Repair or convert compatible copies for difficult local audio formats when helper tools are installed.
- Build smarter shuffle-style playlists with fewer repeated artist, album, or cover clusters.
- Avoid blind one-click cleanup. The app is meant to show what will change before you press an action button.

2. Trial mode, Early Access, and website

The app can open without an active license. Trial mode is intentionally limited, but it lets you verify that the app can read a real Music.app playlist and analyze local tracks.

- Trial mode analyzes one playlist at a time, up to 50 local tracks.
- Full-library scans, unlimited playlist analysis, cleanup actions, Repair / Convert, and File Maintenance require Early Access activation.
- Early Access price is currently $19. The expected regular 1.0 price is $39-49 after Early Access.
- The official website includes screenshots of the main workflows: Dashboard, Playlist Compare, Track Usage, Repair / Convert, Audio Inspector, Shuffle Builder, and License state.
- License delivery is manual during Early Access unless automated Paddle fulfillment is enabled later.

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Website: https://local-music-organizer-site.pages.dev/
Required website files: index.html, icon.png, LocalMusicOrganizer_UserGuide.pdf,
screenshots/...
```

3. License and activation

- Open Local Music Organizer and go to the License screen.
- Enter the buyer email used for purchase.
- Click Copy License Request if manual activation is needed.
- Send the request to support or use the license key provided after purchase.
- Enter the license key and activate online.

License checks

- The app checks license status at activation, at startup, and about every 60 minutes while open.

- If the license server is temporarily unavailable, the last successful active check allows up to 24 hours of offline use.
- If a license is revoked after a refund, chargeback, payment dispute, fraud review, or manual admin action, full-version access may stop during a future check. Trial mode remains available.

4. macOS permissions

Music.app Automation

- Required for reading playlists and library records.
- Required for tag editing, playlist removal, and Music.app playback controls.
- Enable it in System Settings -> Privacy & Security -> Automation.

Full Disk Access

- May be required for file/folder checks, missing file scans, physical file searches, and log export.
- Enable it in System Settings -> Privacy & Security -> Full Disk Access if file access is incomplete.

Network access

- Required for activation and license status checks.
- Required for Homebrew/helper installer downloads when you choose to run them.

5. Warm Cache

Music.app automation can be slow with thousands of tracks and many playlists. Warm Cache reads expensive Music.app data once and reuses it across tools.

- Full Library Records Cache feeds Quality checks, Library Duplicates, File Maintenance, and fast library searches.
- Light Music Library Cache feeds Library Map, Track Usage, and repeated matching operations.
- Playlist Membership Cache feeds Playlist Compare, Playlist Duplicates, Track Usage, Health Check selected-playlist mode, and playlist usage protection.
- Repair / Convert skips Music.app cache because it works with local files, CUE sheets, FFmpeg, and helper tools.

> Dashboard full-library scan now reads the current Music.app library directly. It does not reuse a partial background cache, so the Dashboard result should match the full current library rather than a half-warmed cache snapshot.

6. Library Dashboard

Library Dashboard is a safe overview screen for large local Music.app libraries. It is read-only unless you explicitly save or export a report.

- Run Audio Quality Dashboard reads the current Music.app library directly.
- The Dashboard does not depend on background cache state for its main scan result.
- Cards include Records, Empty artist, Low bitrate, No artwork, Missing files, Long tracks, Short tracks, and Other issues.
- Short tracks are tracked separately from Other issues. The default short-track threshold is under 20 seconds when duration is known.
- No artwork is detected using Music.app artwork data and related issue notes.
- Other issues is reserved for unusual or secondary items, such as uppercase extension or unusual sample-rate/filename/path findings.
- Dashboard logs and saved lists use readable track blocks with blank lines between described tracks/files.

7. Track Usage

Track Usage helps you find a track or file before deleting, repairing, moving, or replacing it. It has two practical paths: fast filesystem search and Music.app playlist scan.

Search behavior

- Press Enter in the Track Usage search field to run Find File on Disk.
- Find File on Disk searches physical files under the selected root and does not read every Music.app playlist.
- If a physical result can be matched instantly from cache to a Music.app item, the row shows Play in Music.
- If the result is physical-only, the row shows Preview, which uses Finder-style Quick Look.
- Use Scan Usage when you specifically need Music.app playlist membership. This can be slower on large libraries.

Playback controls

- Play in Music starts Music.app playback without bringing Music.app to the front.
- Preview opens a Finder-style Quick Look preview for physical-only files.
- Stop / Stop Music stops Music.app playback, Quick Look preview, and local preview playback from inside the app.

8. Playlist Compare and duplicate tools

Playlist Compare

- Compares two playlists and shows shared/repeated tracks.
- Play A / Play B starts playback without forcing Music.app to the foreground.
- Stop stops playback from the app.
- Remove from A / Remove from B removes only one playlist entry from that side.
- Remove All from A / Remove All from B removes all currently shown filtered compare rows from that side.
- Bulk removal works on the current filtered compare rows. You can filter first, review the visible list, then remove the shown entries in one action.
- Playlist Compare removal does not delete audio files and does not delete Music.app library records.
- Undo Last Change can restore playlist entries removed by single-row or bulk Playlist Compare actions.
- Playlist Compare logs use readable per-track blocks, with Track number, Status, Track, Note, Path 1, Path 2, and a blank line between tracks.

Playlist Duplicates

- Finds repeated entries inside one playlist.
- Removal affects playlist entries only, not audio files and not Music.app library records.
- Press Enter in the playlist field to start the scan.

Library Duplicates

- Finds Music.app library records pointing to the same local file or exact duplicate candidates.
- Clean all workflows should be used only after review and backup.

9. Health Check

Health Check now has an explicit Scope so the user can see exactly what will be scanned.

Scope: Entire Music.app Library

- Reads the full current Music.app library directly.
- Does not depend on selected playlists.

- Useful for full-library missing files, no-local records, path risk, missing artwork, and local-library health review.

Scope: Selected Playlists

- Scans only selected playlists.
- If no playlist is selected, the scan does not start. The app asks you to select a playlist or change scope.
- Useful for checking one or several playlists without scanning the whole library.

Scope: Physical Folder

- Scans audio files under the selected physical folder.
- Does not read Music.app playlists.
- Useful for checking physical files before importing, repairing, or comparing them to Music.app records.
- Physical Folder scope reports unreadable files, zero-size/very small files, path risks, quarantine attributes, and audio decode risks when detectable.

10. Repair / Convert

Repair / Convert is for mixed formats, legacy files, CUE sheets, audiophile files, and files that may not work well in Music.app. The goal is to create compatible copies while preserving originals.

- The top setup toolbar contains Check Tools, Check Codec Support, Homebrew/helper installers, SACD Extract, OptimFROG download/folder helpers, OptimFROG notes, and Pause Music Cache.
- The queue owns Add Files, Add CUE Sheet, Analyze Queue, Start Conversion, and Clear Queue.
- You can click Add Files / Add CUE Sheet or drag audio/CUE files onto the buttons or drop zone.
- Analyze Queue refreshes detected names, tags, ranges, codec/source info, and CUE parsing before conversion.
- Start Conversion converts selected queue items. Successfully converted items are removed from the queue after completion so they are not accidentally converted again.
- Failed or unconverted queue items remain in the list for review or retry.
- Default output naming is Artist - Title. The app avoids duplicated artist prefixes such as Artist - Artist - Title when tags or filenames already include the artist.

Output profiles

- ALAC 16/44.1 M4A remains the recommended default for Music.app and iPhone-friendly Apple Lossless copies.
- ALAC 24-bit Archive M4A is optional. It is not selected by default.
- The 24-bit archive profile preserves source sample rate when possible and creates larger files.
- For everyday listening, 24-bit output is normally not audibly different from a correct 16-bit lossless copy. Use it only when you specifically want an archive-quality copy from a hi-res source.
- Do not upsample 16-bit sources just for appearance. Bigger files do not automatically mean better audible quality.

CUE behavior

- Multi-file CUE: each FILE entry is treated as its own source track and converted separately. The app does not incorrectly split these as one album file.
- Single-file CUE: one large album file is split by INDEX 01 ranges.
- The queue summary reports CUE mode, source audio file count, and first source so it is clear what will happen.

Preservation rule

Do not replace or delete your original archive files until you have inspected and listened to the converted copies. For rare formats, keep the original source even after creating a compatible Music.app copy.

11. Helper tools and setup order

- Open Repair / Convert and click Check Tools.
- If brew is missing, click Install Homebrew. macOS may ask to install Apple Command Line Tools; this is not the full Xcode app.
- Use Open Terminal Installer for FFmpeg and LAME.
- Use Install Old-School Helpers for xmp and WavPack tools if needed.
- Use Install SACD Extract only if you use SACD ISO files.
- For OFR/OFS, use Open OptimFROG Download Page, Open ~/.local/bin Folder, and Copy OptimFROG Notes.
- Return to the app and click Check Tools again.

12. OptimFROG OFR/OFS setup

OptimFROG support is optional. It is only needed for rare .ofr / .ofs collections.

Why it is not bundled

OptimFROG is third-party software by its original author. Local Music Organizer does not bundle, redistribute, or automatically install OptimFROG. The app only detects a user-installed decoder and uses it when the user chooses to convert OFR/OFS files.

Official download page

```
http://losslessaudio.org/Downloads.php
```

Recommended installation

- Click Open OptimFROG Download Page in Local Music Organizer.
- Download the macOS / Darwin x64 OptimFROG package.
- Unzip the package.
- Click Open ~/.local/bin Folder in Local Music Organizer.
- Drag the executable named ofr into that folder.
- Click Check Tools.

Expected path

```
~/.local/bin/ofr
```

If macOS blocks the file

```
chmod +x ~/.local/bin/ofr
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine ~/.local/bin/ofr
```

Successful detection

```
OptimFROG decoder: /Users/yourname/.local/bin/ofr
```

13. Stop behavior and log files

Stop should feel immediate. When you press Stop during a scan, the UI should leave the running state immediately and show Stopped. Background work may finish the current tiny system chunk, but the app should not continue the next playlist, folder, or source.

- Stopped scans should not write a log file.
- Log files are for completed scans or completed actions only.

- A stopped operation should not later overwrite the UI as complete or show a stale log path.
- Repair / Convert can terminate an active external converter process when Stop is pressed.
- TXT logs are formatted as readable blocks. Each described track/file should be separated by a blank line.
- Playlist Compare logs now use multi-line track blocks rather than one long pipe-separated row per track.

14. Enter key shortcuts

- Track Usage search field: Enter runs Find File on Disk.
- Playlist Duplicates playlist field: Enter starts Scan Playlist Duplicates.
- License email/key fields: Enter activates when both fields are filled.
- Shuffle Builder fields: Enter runs Preview, not a destructive playlist write.
- Destructive or write-heavy actions still require explicit button clicks.

15. Safety rules

- Keep a backup of important Music.app libraries and audio folders before cleanup.
- Scans are read-only until you press a specific action button.
- Playlist removal actions remove playlist entries, not physical audio files.
- Tag edits are explicit and are sent to Music.app.
- Repair / Convert should create compatible copies; originals should be preserved until reviewed.
- Bulk actions, such as Remove All from A/B, require confirmation and are covered by Undo Last Change when supported.

16. Troubleshooting

Music.app does not play

- Check System Settings -> Privacy & Security -> Automation and allow Local Music Organizer to control Music.app.
- For Track Usage physical-only rows, use Preview. Music.app playback only works instantly when the row has a persistent ID or a cached Music.app match.

Find File on Disk shows Preview only

- This means the row is a physical file result, not a cached Music.app record.
- Run Warm Cache or Scan Usage if you need playlist membership and Music.app-backed rows.

Dashboard count looks smaller than the library

- Use the latest build. Dashboard should read the full current Music.app library directly and should not rely on a partial background cache.

Selected Playlists Health Check does not start

- This is intentional. Select at least one playlist or change Scope to Entire Music.app Library or Physical Folder.

Repair / Convert does not see helper tools

- Click Check Tools.
- Install Homebrew and FFmpeg/LAME if missing.
- Restart the app after installing tools if Terminal changed PATH.
- For OptimFROG, confirm that the file is named exactly ofr and is located at ~/.local/bin/ofr.

OptimFROG decoder still says not found

- Click Open ~/.local/bin Folder and confirm the ofr file is there.
- Run chmod +x ~/.local/bin/ofr.
- Run xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine ~/.local/bin/ofr.
- Return to the app and click Check Tools again.

Manual link does not open on the website

- The PDF file must be named exactly LocalMusicOrganizer_UserGuide.pdf.
- Do not upload LocalMusicOrganizer_UserGuide.pdf.pdf.

17. Support, refunds, and revocation

- Support email: sergeyappleservice@gmail.com.
- Refund requests are reviewed manually and should be submitted within 14 days of purchase.
- Trial mode is available before purchase so users can confirm that the app can read their Music.app library.
- A refund, chargeback, payment dispute, fraud review, or manual license review may revoke the license on the server.
- License keys are generated manually during Early Access unless automated Paddle fulfillment is enabled later.